

Maritime Southeast Asia

The tropical island nations off the southeast coast of Asia include Indonesia—the largest archipelago in the world with more than 18,000 islands.

Philippines

The Philippines are the second-largest producer of coconuts in the world. They are used to make many useful products.

BASKETS MADE FROM PALM LEAVES



MATS MADE FROM THE COCONUT'S OUTER HUSK



COCONUT MEAT AND MILK IS USED IN COOKING



Indonesia

Gamelans—tuned percussion orchestras—accompany dancers in ritual and religious ceremonies.

Let's drum up support.

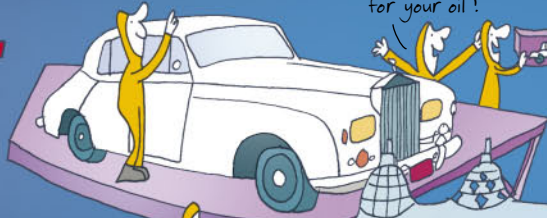
Brunei

Following the discovery of oil underneath this tiny kingdom, Brunei is today one of the world's richest countries.

I play the oil drum.



Some cars for your oil?



East Timor

The waters off this tiny nation contain one of the richest oil fields in the world outside the Middle East.

Myanmar (Burma)

The deep-red rubies mined in Burma are considered to be the best in the world.

You're the best.



Malaysia

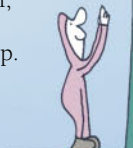
Malaysia is one of the world's top producers of palm oil, from coconuts, used in cooking and to make soap.



Top stuff!

Thailand

Many of the markets in Bangkok, the Thai capital, are on the water, with traders selling their goods from floating sampans.



Laos

Meaning "Mother of rivers," the Mekong in Laos is a rich source of fish, irrigation water for the paddy fields, and serves as the country's main watery highway.



Southeast Asia

Seven nations are crowded onto the southeast Asian peninsula. Their peoples are a mix of Hindus, Buddhists, and Muslims with a rich mixture of beliefs and cultures.



Singapore

The island nation of Singapore is the world's busiest port, handling ships from China, Japan, the Middle East, and Europe.

Vietnam

Much of Vietnam's farmland is underwater during the year, since the country is a leading producer and exporter of rice.

What a pretty paddy.



Cambodia

Once the center of the Khmer Empire, Cambodia's jungles reveal such structures as the vast 12th-century temple of Angkor Wat.

Angkor what?

North Korea

The root of the ginseng plant, grown in both North and South Korea, is believed to nurture good health and energy.

South Korea

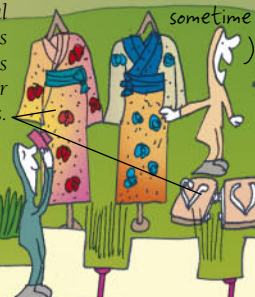
One-third of the world's new ships come from South Korean shipyards, which work at an impressive rate to complete a new ship once every four working days!

It's ship shape.



Traditional Japanese dress includes kimonos and geta, or wooden clogs.

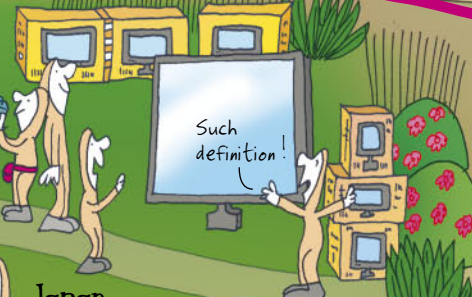
Kimono over sometime.



Japan

The Japanese excel at making electronic goods, leading the world in computers and consumer goods.

Such definition!



Japan and Korea

Both South Korea and the island nation of Japan have highly developed industrial economies, producing everything from ships and cars to computers and high-definition televisions.

Chinese food

Star anise and other spices are used to flavor Chinese food, which is eaten out of small bowls using two wooden sticks known as chopsticks.

Chop, chop!



Panda

Found only in China, there are only about 1,600 of the lovable giant pandas surviving in the wild today.

I'll pander to your every need.



Taiwan

The offshore island of Taiwan relies on its exports of electronic and electrical goods, which have made it one of the world's most successful industrial economies.

Get off your high horse!



Horse skills

Riding horses for pleasure, racing, hunting, and sport, many Mongols are highly skilled horse riders.

Don't be a neigh sayer.



Mongolia

Mongolia is one of the most sparsely populated countries in the world, with many of its nomadic people living in traditional felt yurts or tents.

